

5.1.3 Internet Explorer 7

People who have limited knowledge of Windows, mostly first-time owners, are more likely to use IE because it is already bundled with the operating system. Unfortunately, the popularity of Windows and the limited knowledge regarding online threats among IE users make IE a favourite entry point for malware.

At least from the security perspective, IE 7 is a must-upgrade for these users. The latest iteration of IE, besides being considered to be more secure than the previous versions, also includes tabbed browsing and RSS feed subscription. But for the strict Windows genuineness check during installation, IE7 would have found its way into the PCs of most Indian users.

Maxthon

This browser is built around IE and utilises IE as the browsing engine. But it vastly improves the features offered and makes the interface more user-friendly. It is not considered wise to use IE except as Maxthon. Some of the features that Maxthon adds to IE 6 include:



The download control in Maxthon

- Tabbed Browsing: This, too, allows all open tabs to be saved as a group. It also makes it possible to restore all the tabs of a previous browsing session.
- Easier access to options : Settings buried deep inside IE are now easily accessible under the Options Download Control and Ad Hunter menu. This includes controlling pop-ups, Flash objects, JavaScript, etc. besides ad blocking.
- RSS feed reader client: Maxthon incorporates a feed client. A pop-up informs the user if the page being browsed offers an RSS feed. Feed subscription requires just a couple of clicks.
- Tools: Maxthon bundles a lot of thoughtful extras that make life easier. Quick access buttons to sites like del.icio.us and technorati.com allow easy submissions. There is easier access to trans-